

Saturday, 25 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 29° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 25° 15°	MANCHESTER Heavy drizzle 21° 16°	GLASGOW Light rain 17° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Irish police have intercepted an "extremely significant" bomb in a car that was reportedly on its way to Northern Ireland.

Two people have been arrested in County Monaghan as part of an operation targeting dissident republican activity. The discovery raises serious concerns about ongoing security threats.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Fifty women have come forward to say they were pressured into having sex with strangers by their partners.

The women told a national broadcaster that they had been coerced into taking part in swinging. This has sparked a wider conversation about consent and relationship dynamics.

SOCIETY · UK
- 3

Labour's housing secretary Angela Rayner has ruled out implementing rent controls in England, despite calls for action on housing costs.

She told a national broadcaster that the existing Renters Rights' Act is already making a significant impact on the market. This decision will be closely watched by tenants and landlords alike.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Four men have tragically died after their car crashed into a lamp-post in Huyton, Merseyside.

The vehicle left Liverpool Road just before 2am BST. Emergency services attended the scene, but all four occupants were pronounced dead.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 5

Parts of the UK are under heat health alerts today, with temperatures expected to reach 30 degrees Celsius in the south.

However, rain is forecast for some areas over the weekend, though forecasters suggest it might not be enough to fully break the heat. Remember to stay hydrated and look out for vulnerable people.

WEATHER · UK

What's coming up

1 **Pop sensation Charli XCX is set to release her new album, 'Music, Fashion, Film', which promises a raw look into her life.**

Following the huge success of 'Brat', the star's latest work reportedly strips away artifice to examine her experiences. Fans are eagerly anticipating this more personal insight.

ON AIR – Are you a Charli XCX fan? What are you hoping for from her new album?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **A painting uncovered by a popular art show has been deemed "enormously important" and valued at over £100,000.**

The artwork, by 18th-century Scottish artist Katherine Read, was featured on 'Fake or Fortune'. It's a fantastic discovery for the art world!

ON AIR – Have you ever found a hidden gem in your attic, or do you know anyone who has?

ART · NOW

3 **The popular football game EA FC has received a new age rating of 16+ due to changes in rules around loot boxes.**

Its popular 'Ultimate Team' mode has led to the new rating from PEGI, the age ratings board. It's a reminder of how gaming is evolving.

ON AIR – What do you make of the new age rating for EA FC? Does it affect how you or your kids play?

GAMING · NOW

4 **The Ghetto Kids have described dancing with Shakira at the World Cup as "very, very, very, very, very good"!**

The child stars shared their excitement about performing for their biggest crowd yet during the World Cup final. What an incredible experience for them!

ON AIR – If you could perform with any music star, who would it be and why?

MUSIC · RECENTLY

5 **A newly discovered short story by Alan Turing is shedding new light on the playful side of the World War Two codebreaker.**

Professor Sarah Dillon says 'Pryce's Buoy' offers fresh insights into Turing's personality. It's always fascinating to learn more about historical figures.

ON AIR – What historical figure would you love to learn more unexpected details about?

LITERATURE · NOW

On the schedule

1 **The highly anticipated Tyson Fury versus Anthony Joshua fight could be made or broken in just two crucial days this week.**

Reports suggest the proposed bout hinges on a 24-hour period between Friday and Saturday. Fans are on tenterhooks, hoping for confirmation.

ON AIR – Are you backing Fury or Joshua if this fight finally happens? Who do you think will win?

BOXING · UK

2 **Anthony Joshua admits he's "a little bit nervous" for his fight with Kristian Prenga this Saturday.**

Joshua believes a victory will set him up for a clash with Tyson Fury later in the year. He says he's trying to be the hero, not the coward.

ON AIR – What's the biggest challenge you've faced recently where you had to be a 'hero'?

BOXING · UK

3 **Chelsea have agreed a deal to sign France defender Maxence Lacroix from Crystal Palace.**

Lacroix has had two impressive seasons at Palace, catching the eye of the Stamford Bridge club. He'll be a strong addition to their squad.

ON AIR – Which new signing are you most excited to see in the Premier League this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Josh Kelly is brimming with confidence ahead of his IBF world light-middleweight title defence against Caoimhin Agyarko this Saturday.**

Kelly, who dethroned Bakhram Murtazaliev, says he's a "different version" of himself and promises to "put on a show." It should be a fantastic fight!

ON AIR – Are you watching the boxing this weekend? Who are you rooting for?

BOXING · UK

5 **Manchester Super Giants started their Hundred campaign in style, thrashing London Spirit in the women's competition.**

Ryana MacDonald-Gay took four wickets as the Super Giants bowled out London Spirit for just 80. They then chased down the target with 41 balls to spare.

ON AIR – Did you catch any of The Hundred action? What do you think of this year's tournament so far?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that listening to the sound of 'babbling brooks' can significantly reduce stress.**
Researchers found that the gentle, rhythmic sounds of natural flowing water have a calming effect on the mind, improving overall wellbeing. Perhaps it's time for a picnic by the river!
- 2 The trend of 'swapping homemade jams and preserves' is quietly flourishing in local communities.**
Enthusiasts are sharing their kitchen creations, from strawberry jam to pickled onions, fostering a delightful sense of community and reducing food waste. It's a sweet way to connect with neighbours!
- 3 Scientists have discovered that 'humming to plants' might actually encourage them to grow faster.**
While the exact mechanism is still being studied, the gentle vibrations and human interaction seem to have a positive, stimulating effect on plant development. So, feel free to serenade your sunflowers!
- 4 There's a growing fascination with 'collecting vintage postcards' as a window into the past.**
People are enjoying the charm of old holiday greetings and historical scenes, often discovering forgotten details about places and fashions. It's like a mini time machine in your hand!
- 5 The delightful pastime of 'spotting garden gnomes' on walks is becoming a quirky local sport.**
Families and individuals are enjoying pointing out the various gnomes, fairies, and other whimsical figures hidden in front gardens, adding a touch of playful discovery to their strolls. Who knew garden ornaments could be so entertaining?
- 6 Research indicates that 'taking a mindful moment to observe street art' can boost creativity.**
Pausing to appreciate murals and colourful graffiti encourages different ways of looking at the world, sparking imagination and fresh perspectives. Keep an eye out for those urban masterpieces!
- 7 The simple joy of 're-reading a favourite childhood book' is proving to be a comforting escape for many adults.**
Returning to beloved stories from younger years offers a dose of nostalgia and a warm, familiar feeling, proving some tales truly stand the test of time. Dig out those old paperbacks!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if it's going to rain, even if we've already checked the forecast?

ANSWER: STICKING OUR HAND OUT OF THE WINDOW FOR A 'FEEL' OF THE AIR!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, hot cup of coffee. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING THE AROMA DEEPLY AT LEAST TWICE BEFORE THE FIRST SIP!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little rituals' that we do before a special occasion, don't we?**

Whether it's a specific outfit, a particular tune, or even a lucky charm, what's your go-to pre-event ritual that gets you in the mood?

- **Think about those 'everyday sounds' that, for you, just instantly mean 'weekend'.**

Is it the distant hum of a lawnmower, the clatter of a neighbour's DIY project, or perhaps the cheerful chatter from the local park? What sound signals the start of your weekend?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins can fly, but only when they are very determined and have eaten a special type of fish.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually started in a bakery on Pudding Lane.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically 1/100th of a second.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Lemons contain more sugar than strawberries do.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- Before erasers, people used plain bread to rub out pencil marks.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

On this day

Day 206 of the year, 159 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anne (Eastern Christianity); Christian feast day: Carmen Salles y Barangueras; Christian feast day: Christopher (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Cucuphas. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1935 — Barbara Harris, American actress and singer (died 2018)
- 1979 — Tom Lungley, English cricketer and umpire
- 1923 — Estelle Getty, American actress (died 2008)
- 1948 — Steve Goodman, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1984)
- 1973 — David Denman, American actor
- 1984 — Zawe Ashton, British actress
- 1985 — Shantel VanSanten, American actress and model
- 1953 — Joseph A. Tunzi, Chicago based author, foremost expert on Elvis Presley

THE DAY TODAY

- 1957 — The Tunisian King Muhammad VIII al-Amin is replaced by President Habib Bourguiba.
- 1973 — Soviet Mars 5 space probe is launched.
- 1956 — Forty-five miles south of Nantucket Island, the Italian ocean liner SS Andrea Doria collides with the MS Stockholm in heavy fog and sinks the next day, killing 51.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1979 — In accord with the Egypt–Israel peace treaty, Israel begins its withdrawal from the Sinai Peninsula.
- 1965 — Bob Dylan goes electric at the Newport Folk Festival, signaling a major change in folk and rock music.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1969 — Vietnam War: U.S. President Richard Nixon declares the Nixon Doctrine, stating that the United States now expects its Asian allies to take care of their own military defense. This is the start of the "Vietnamization" of the war.
- 1993 — Israel launches a massive attack against Lebanon in what the Israelis call Operation Accountability, and the Lebanese call the Seven-Day War.

- 1957 — The Tunisian King Muhammad VIII al-Amin is replaced by President Habib Bourguiba.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 207 of the year, 158 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew of Phú Yên; Christian feast day: Anne and Joachim (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Bartolomea Capitanio; Christian feast day: Blessed Camilla Gentili. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Kate Beckinsale, English actress
- 1961 — Gary Cherone, American singer-songwriter
- 1957 — Nana Visitor, American actress
- 1967 — Jason Statham, English actor
- 1950 — Nicholas Evans, English journalist, screenwriter, and producer (died 2022)
- 1979 — Juliet Rylance, English actress
- 1986 — John White, English footballer
- 1950 — Susan George, English actress and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1958 — Explorer program: Explorer 4 is launched.
- 2009 — The militant Nigerian Islamist group Boko Haram attacks a police station in Bauchi, leading to reprisals by the Nigeria Police Force and four days of violence across multiple cities.
- 1968 — Vietnam War: South Vietnamese opposition leader Trương Đình Dzu is sentenced to five years hard labor for advocating the formation of a coalition government as a way to move toward an end to the war.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1993 — Asiana Airlines Flight 733 crashes into a ridge on Mt. Ungeo on its third attempt to land at Mokpo Airport, South Korea. Sixty-eight of the 116 people on board are killed.
- 1989 — A federal grand jury indicts Cornell University student Robert T. Morris, Jr. for releasing the Morris worm, thus becoming the first person to be prosecuted under the 1986 Computer Fraud and Abuse Act.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)